AGA KHAN UNIVERSITY EXAMINATION BOARD

SECONDARY SCHOOL CERTIFICATE

CLASS X EXAMINATION 2010

English Compulsory Paper II

Time allowed: 2 hours 15 minutes Marks 43

INSTRUCTIONS

Please read the following instructions carefully.

1. Check your name and school information. Sign that it is correct.

I agree that this is my name and school. **Candidate's signature**

2. RUBRIC. There are THREE questions. Answer ALL THREE questions. Question 2 offers TWO choices and Question 3 offers THREE choices. Attempt any ONE of the options in each.

3. When answering the questions:

   Read each question carefully.
   Use ONLY black ink.
   Do not use staples, paper clips, glue, correcting fluid or ink erasers.
   DO NOT write outside the answer box.
   Complete your answer in the allocated space only.

4. The marks for the questions are shown in brackets ( ).

Q.1. (Total 10 Marks)

Read the passage and answer all the questions that follow:

How many things can you see in the night sky? A lot! On a clear night you might see the Moon, some planets, and thousands of sparkling stars.

You can see even more with a telescope. You might see stars where before you only saw dark space. You might see that many stars look larger than others. You might see that some stars that look white are really red or blue. With bigger and bigger telescopes you can see more and more objects in the sky. And you can see those objects in more and more detail.

But scientists believe there are some things in the sky that we will never see. We won't see them with the biggest telescope in the world, on the clearest night of the year. That's because they're invisible. They're the mysterious dead stars called black holes.

You might find it hard to imagine that stars die. After all, our sun is a star. Year after year we see it up in the sky, burning brightly, giving us heat and light. The sun certainly doesn't seem to be getting old or weak. But stars do burn out and die after billions of years.

As a star's gases burn, they give off light and heat. But when the gas runs out, the star stops burning and begins to die.

As the star cools, the outer layers of the star pull in towards the centre. The star squashes into a smaller and smaller ball. If the star was very small, the star ends up as a cold, dark ball called a black dwarf. If the star was very big, it keeps squashing inward until it's packed together tighter than anything in the universe.

Imagine if the Earth were crushed until it was the size of a tiny marble. That's how tightly this dead star, a black hole, is packed. What pulls the star in toward its centre with such power? It's the same force that pulls you down when you jump---the force called gravity. A black hole is so tightly packed that its gravity sucks in everything --- even light. The light from a black hole can never come back to your eyes. That's why you see nothing but blackness.

So the next time you stare up at the night sky, remember: there's more in the sky than meets the eye! Scattered in the silent darkness are black holes ---the great mystery of space.

Source: Article on Black Holes

a. State any THREE facts about the stars. (3 Marks)

b. Why cannot the black holes be seen? (3 Marks)

c. Why are black holes called the 'mysterious dead stars'? (4 Marks)

Q.2. (Total 15 Marks)

Compose a response of about 120 words to any ONE of the options a or b.

EITHER

a. You have been asked to organize an outing at the end of the school term. Write a letter to the school principal requesting necessary arrangements.

OR

b. There have been some unusual noises every night for the last five nights near where you live. They happen at the same time every night. Your family members and neighbours are very upset. Last night, as you saw something unusual happening and you now decide to report it to the police. Write your report giving all the details.

Make your notes here. Write the final draft on page 5.

Option _____

Q.3. (Total 18 Marks)

Write a composition of about 200 words on any ONE of the options a, b or c.
Remember to compose the final draft in complete sentences.

EITHER

a. Many people believe that honesty is the best policy. In your opinion is it ever acceptable to lie? Write an essay stating your opinion and supporting it with convincing examples and detailed reasons.

OR

b. Computers are more of a menace than a blessing. Support or refute the statement in an essay with sound evidence and reasons. Be sure to explain your reasons in detail.

OR

c. It has been said that television has little real educational value. What is your opinion on this issue? Write an essay stating your opinion and supporting it with convincing reasons.

Make your notes here. Write the final draft on pages 7 and 8.

Option _____

PLEASE TURN OVER THE PAGE

END OF PAPER